

ZHIYI JIN

PhD Candidate / Researcher

ICS, Department of Sociology, University of Groningen

Department of Social and Cultural Anthropology, Autonomous University of Barcelona

z.jin@rug.nl | Zhiyi.Jin@uab.cat

Research Interests

- Social network analysis, Spatial context, Computational Social Science
- My research focuses on how spatial contexts shape network composition and link to patterns of inequality, particularly in urban and rural settings. I draw on social capital theory to understand how access to resources through acquaintance networks varies across socioeconomic groups and geographical areas. I am interested in opportunity structures and how regional opportunity structures influence social ties. Through quantitative analysis, I aim to uncover mechanisms connecting place, social ties, and inequality in contemporary societies.

Education

PhD in Sociology

ICS, Department of Sociology, University of Groningen, the Netherlands

Autonomous University of Barcelona, Spain (2022–Present)

- **Topic:** "How Place Shapes Connection: Social Capital and Acquaintanceship Networks Across Regions" (Supervisors: Miranda Lubbers, Marijtje van Duijn, Christian Steglich, Michał Bojanowski)

MSc in Computational Social Science

Linköping University, Sweden (2020 – 2022)

- **Thesis:** The Moderating Role of Relative Wealth on Microfinance Diffusion (Supervisor: Christian Steglich; Examiner: Karl Wennberg)

MSc in Marketing

University of Bath, United Kingdom (2016 - 2017)

- **Graduate Project** for Nationwide Building Society: Understanding factors influencing consumer trust in online financial services (Advisor: Phil Tomlinson)

BA in Advertising

South China University of Technology, Guangzhou, China (2012-2016)

- **Thesis:** "The Impact of Recommendation Content and Customer Perceived Value on Context-Aware Marketing Effectiveness: The Case of Cebu Pacific Air Company" (Advisor: Chunlin Duan)

Research & Activity

Academic trainings

International Winter Course – Personal Networks: Theory, Methods and Applications | GRAFO Research Group, Autonomous University of Barcelona | January 2023

Interuniversity Center for Social Science Theory and Methodology (ICS) – PhD Courses

- Introduction to Theory Construction and Modeling | September – December 2023
- ICS Forum Day, Amsterdam – Presented research plan | December 2023
- Writing the First Paper | January – June 2024
- ICS Spring Day, Nijmegen – Presented ongoing research | June 2024

Introduction to Programming Using Python | Evening Course by Center for Information Technology (CIT), University of Groningen | September – December 2024

Introduction to ArcGIS | Workshop by Geodienst, University of Groningen | March 2025

Elements of AI | Online Course by the University of Helsinki | Completed June 2025

Video Publications

van Herwijnen, N., Targarona Rifa, N., **Jin, Z.**, & Planas, P. (2025, May 21). How can personal networks enforce social cohesion? Introducing the PATCHWORK research project [Video].

Vimeo. <https://vimeo.com/1086346883>

- This video introduces the ERC-funded PATCHWORK project, illustrating how personal networks relate to social cohesion in four EU countries.

Conference Presentation

- *“Regional Differences in Socioeconomic Assortativity of Acquaintanceship Ties”*, INSNA Sunbelt Conference, Paris, June 2025 (upcoming).

- *“Regional Differences in Socioeconomic Assortativity of Acquaintanceship Ties”*, Interdisciplinary Conference on Social Norms, Cohesion, and (De)Polarization, Utrecht, May 2025.

- *“Measuring Bridging Social Capital and its Spatial Disparity Based on Acquaintanceships”*, INSNA Sunbelt Conference, Edinburgh, June 2024.

Skills

- Software: R, Python

- Languages: Chinese (native), English (fluent), Japanese (basic)